

June

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Also on this day

1969 *The Very Hungry Caterpillar*, a bestselling children's book by US writer Eric Carle, was published.

1992 **The Earth Summit**, a UN conference on environmental issues, began in Rio de Janeiro, Brazil.

1992 **The High Court of Australia** ruled that First Australian communities had the legal right to own their ancestral lands.

2017

Climbing El Capitan

US climber Alex Honnold became the first person to scale the massive El Capitan rock formation in Yosemite National Park, California, USA, without any ropes or safety equipment.

Born this day

1986 Rafael Nadal, Spanish tennis player. He has won 20 Grand Slam singles tournaments, including a record 13 French Open titles. Between 2005 and 2007, he won 81 consecutive matches on clay courts – a record – and is widely agreed to be the greatest clay court player of all time.



2010 Preparing for Mars

A group of six volunteers went into isolation to experience the conditions of a mission to Mars. As part of an experiment called MARS-500, they were locked away in a chamber in Russia for 520 days – the duration of a real Mars mission – with little contact with the outside world. Scientists studied the effects on their health to help prepare for a future crewed flight to the Red Planet.